
OPERATIONS GUIDE

How Eswachh works, end to end

Everything the platform does today, who can do it, what runs by itself overnight, and what is built but deliberately switched off.

FOR	Owners, administrators, and anyone explaining the system to a client
COVERS	The public site, the office, the customer portal and the cleaner's round
COMPANION	developer-guide.pdf, for how any of it is changed
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The whole system in one page

If you read nothing else, read this. Everything after it is detail.

Three websites, one system

ADDRESS	WHO USES IT
/	The public. Prices, signup, renewal.
/app	The office. You, franchise owners, cleaners.
/my	Customers, after they sign in.

Signing in sends each person to the right one. Nobody chooses.

Who sees which customers

A **sector** is a territory. Staff are given sectors on the **People** screen. A customer belongs to one sector. If the two match, that member of staff can see that customer. If not, the customer does not exist for them.

Give a sector to somebody else and it takes effect immediately. Money already collected stays with whoever collected it.

Money: two rules that never bend

- **The server works out every price.** Nothing the browser sends is trusted. The figure a customer sees is a quote.
- **Nothing counts as paid until the bank confirms it.** Not when the customer clicks pay — when Razorpay confirms.

Messages

Customers are messaged automatically: welcome, receipt, renewal chase, cleaning done, and more. **Nothing is ever sent from a test copy.** It is written down as if it had been sent, with the reason it was held back, so you can check the wording safely.

Once a plan runs out, the customer is asked **every day** until they renew. When the plan is paused, the message changes but the daily rhythm does not. Marking a plan **Ended** is what stops it.

What runs by itself, every night

Backups, renewal chasing, pausing unpaid plans, tidying old records. You do not start any of it. It needs one cron entry on the server; see the deployment notes.

What you can change without a developer

Settings holds the business name, contact details, invoice wording, the policy pages, how many days before a plan is paused, how often customers are chased, and the switches that

hide the blog, the team page and the cloth service. **Masters** holds prices and geography. **Messages** holds the wording of every message.

THE THREE QUESTIONS PEOPLE ASK MOST

"Why can this franchise not see that customer?" The customer is in a sector that person does not hold. People screen.

"Why did the price change?" Somebody edited a master, or the customer's society carries a surcharge. Both show on the plan.

"Why did no message go out?" Either this is a test copy, or the wording is switched off on the Messages screen.

CONTENTS

What is in this guide

- | | |
|----|--|
| 01 | The shape of the thing
Three doors into one system, and how territory works |
| 02 | What a customer can do
The four choices, and what each one sets off |
| 03 | Inside a customer's account
Plans, adding a second car, payments, complaints |
| 04 | The office, screen by screen
All seventeen pages and what each is for |
| 05 | Who is allowed to do what
Four roles, and custom roles for the rest |
| 06 | Money
How a price is worked out, and what counts as paid |
| 07 | Messages
All fifteen, when they fire, and the delivery switch |
| 08 | What happens overnight
Six jobs, and the order they run in |
| 09 | Built, but switched off
What is hidden today and what turning it on involves |
| 10 | What you can change yourself
Every setting, without needing a developer |
| 11 | Keeping the data safe
Backups, retention, and what a sector-scoped user cannot see |

The shape of the thing

- 1.1 There is one system and one database. What changes is which door you came in through, and each door shows a different building.

DOOR	ADDRESS	WHO USES IT
The public site	/	Anybody. Prices, packages, advice articles, the team, questions, contact, and the signup and renewal forms.
The office	/app	Administrators, franchise owners and cleaners. Everything operational.
A customer's account	/my	Customers only. Their cars, their money, their complaints.

Signing in at `/login` sends a person to whichever of the last two is theirs. Nobody chooses; the role decides. A customer who reaches an office address is returned to their own pages, and the reverse is also true.

1.2

Sectors are the territory

The business is divided into **sectors** — the neighbourhoods it services. Each customer lives in one, and each member of staff is given the ones they cover. That single pairing decides everything:

You see the customers in the sectors you cover. Nobody else's, and nothing else decides it.

A franchise user covering four neighbourhoods simply holds four sectors. Two people can cover the same sector — an owner and the cleaners working it — and somebody covering none sees nothing at all.

Asking for a record in a sector you do not cover produces the same answer as asking for one that was never created. Only an **administrator** sees every sector, and there is a sector filter in the top bar for narrowing the screens to one.

Setting somebody up

Two steps, in this order, as an administrator.

- 01 **Masters → Geography → Sectors.** Add the sector if it does not exist yet, and add its societies beneath it.
- 02 **People → Add.** Create the login, pick the role, and **tick the sectors they cover.** That tick is the whole of **who-sees-what** — it takes effect immediately, and an account with nothing ticked signs in to empty screens.

HANDING WORK TO SOMEBODY ELSE

Change the ticks. That is all. Nothing is migrated, no customer record is touched, and it takes effect on their next screen — so it is also instantly reversible if it was a mistake.

The People list shows each person's sectors, and flags anyone covering **None**, because that is an account that will report nothing is wrong while seeing nothing at all.

One thing that does not move

Payments stay with whoever took them. Hand a sector to somebody else and they get the customers and the plans from that moment, but the revenue already collected — and last year's figures — stay exactly as they were. Money is a record of something that happened, not a view that can be rearranged.

What a customer can do

- 2.1 Four things, and they are the four the requirements document asks for. Everything else on the public site is reading material.

CHOICE	WHAT IT DOES	STATUS
Subscribe	A new customer takes out a plan on a car.	LIVE
Renew	An existing customer extends a plan that is running out, by car number.	LIVE
Cloth top-up	Buys more ironing cloths against a running plan.	HIDDEN
Raise a complaint	Reports a problem, which reaches the cleaner the same minute.	LIVE

ON THE CLOTH SERVICE

It is built, tested and working on both sides — the customer's top-up page, the cleaner's pickup and delivery screens, the balance ledger and the low-balance warning. It is switched off business-wide while the business decides whether to run it. Section 09 covers what turning it on involves.

2.2

Subscribing, step by step

- 01 **They enter their mobile number** and we send a code to it. Nothing is created yet.
- 02 **The code proves the number.** A number we already hold is turned away with an invitation to sign in — one person, one account.
- 03 **They give their details and their car:** name, address, society, car number, model, package, how much interior cleaning, and for how long.
- 04 **A price appears** as they choose. It is a quote for display only; the real figure is worked out again on our side when they pay.
- 05 **They pay.** The plan is created as *pending* and a payment record is opened before the payment window appears, so an abandoned checkout still leaves something to chase.
- 06 **The gateway confirms.** Only then does the plan become active. Two messages go out: a welcome to the customer, and an alert to the office that a new car needs a cleaner.

The new car now sits on the **unassigned** list until somebody gives it to a cleaner. That list is the first thing the office sees.

Renewing

From the public site a customer types their car number, sees the plan and what it will cost, and pays. From inside their account they press Renew on the plan itself, and — as in the previous system — may change the package, the amount of interior cleaning and the length before paying.

Changing any of those **reprices the plan before the payment window opens**. A customer who switches from one month to six is charged for six.

What the new dates are

A renewed term begins the day the last one ended, not the day the money arrived. A plan that ran to the 10th and is renewed on the 17th runs from the 10th — the chain has no holes in it, and the renewal date stays where it has always been instead of walking a little further into the month every year.

That is also what the customer was given. A plan a few days past its date is still being cleaned, because the round keeps going through the grace period before anything is put on hold — so starting the new term at the payment date charged for a full month and quietly gave those days away.

THE ONE EXCEPTION

A plan left unpaid so long that continuing the chain would produce a term that is *already over* starts fresh from today instead. Renewing a plan that lapsed eight months ago cannot issue a month that expired in March, so there is nothing to continue and it begins now.

So which one will it do?

The switch happens when the plan is more than **one whole term** past its date. Until then it carries on; after that it starts again.

A ONE-MONTH
PLAN THAT ENDED

10 AUG	RENEWED ON	NEW TERM
Renewed early	1 Aug	10 Aug → 10 Sept — the days left are added on
Renewed on the day	10 Aug	10 Aug → 10 Sept — no gap
A week late	17 Aug	10 Aug → 10 Sept — carries on from the old date
Four weeks late	7 Sept	10 Aug → 10 Sept — still carries on, just
Six weeks late	21 Sept	21 Sept → 21 Oct — starts fresh

A three-month plan works the same way with a longer fuse: it carries on until it is more than three months late, then starts fresh. A six-month plan, six months.

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO WORK IT OUT

The notice on the renewal screen names the dates before anybody pays — *"Renewing carries on from 10 Aug, not from today — the new term runs to 10 Sept", or "Too long lapsed to carry on. Renewing starts a fresh term today, running to 21 Oct"*. It is the same calculation the payment then writes, not a second opinion, so what it says on screen is what the plan gets.

Renewing early works the same way, from the other side: the new term is added on to the current end date, so a customer who pays a month ahead loses nothing.

That is now said out loud, in all four places a renewal can be started — the public page, the customer's own pages, and the office list for administrators and franchise owners alike. A plan with time still on it says so and explains that the days are not lost; one that has lapsed says how long ago and that it will restart from today. The office sees the same facts worded for somebody taking a payment rather than making one.

IT IS A NOTICE, NOT A GATE

Renewing early is never refused. A customer who wants to pay four months ahead is a customer paying you four months early, and the period is extended from its end date either way — blocking it would only mean the money arrives later. The one case in a warning colour is a plan already past its date, because that one is costing the customer service days.

Paying finishes on a page of its own — what was renewed, the invoice number, what it cost and when the new term runs from — rather than a line of green text under a form the customer has finished with.

While a payment is going through

Every screen that takes money — the public signup, the public renewal, the public cloth top-up, the customer's own renew, top-up and add-a-car, and the office taking a payment over the phone — now covers itself while the payment runs, with a spinner and one instruction:

WHAT IT SAYS

Please wait. Do not click anywhere or refresh the page. This finishes on its own, and you will see a confirmation when it is done.

It cannot be dismissed, and it does not come down until the payment has finished one way or the other. It also stands aside while the gateway's own window is open, because covering that would block the very thing the customer is being asked to use. Closing the browser at the wrong moment now asks the customer to confirm.

Confirmations of payment no longer clear themselves. Assigning a cleaner still says so briefly and then gets out of the way; money changing hands stays on screen until it is closed. Somebody reading an invoice number back down the phone was watching it disappear mid-sentence, which looks exactly like a payment that did not go through.

Raising a complaint

A signed-in customer picks the plan, a category and a priority, and writes what is wrong. The complaint is logged against the plan, and the cleaner assigned to that car is messaged immediately. The office can hand it to somebody else, mark it resolved, and close it — though closing is treated as the customer's word to give, so a cleaner may resolve but not close.

Inside a customer's account

3.1

PAGE	WHAT IT HOLDS
My plans	Every car they have with us, what each is on, when it runs out, and the buttons to renew, add a car, or top up cloths.
My payments	Everything they have paid, with an invoice they can open and print for each one.
My complaints	What they have raised and where each one has got to.
My details	Name, address, contact number, and changing their own password.

3.2

A household with two cars

Adding a second car is done from **My plans**, not from the public signup form. The form asks only for the car and what they want done to it: the address, the society and the phone number are already known, and there is no code to wait for, because being signed in is stronger proof than a code sent to a phone.

Two refusals are deliberate, and both explain themselves:

- A car **already registered to somebody else** — checked across every sector, because a car on somebody else's books is still taken. Finding that out at the payment step would be far worse.
- A car that **already has a running plan**, which is sent to renew instead. Two live plans on one car would be billed twice and cleaned once.

WHY NOT THE PUBLIC FORM

The public signup form proves a mobile number with a code and then refuses numbers it already holds. An existing customer using it would be told their own number was taken. The account route is the only one that can work.

What a signed-in customer no longer sees

HIDDEN

The **Renew** and **Subscribe** buttons are not shown in the header to a customer who is signed in. They do both from their own pages, where their details are already filled in. Staff still see them, and the pages themselves are untouched and still reachable by address.

The office, screen by screen

- 4.1 Nobody sees all of these. The menu is filtered by what the person signed in is allowed to do, so a cleaner's menu is four items long and an administrator's is seventeen.

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHO SEES IT
Dashboard	Today at a glance: money taken, plans running, what is unassigned, what is overdue, what is open.	Everyone
My round	The cleaner's list of cars for today. Each is marked cleaned, skipped or not found, with a note.	Cleaners, owners, admin
Subscriptions	Every plan. Filter, search by car number, assign a cleaner, edit, renew, put on hold, act on many at once.	Owners, admin
Customers	The people. Their cars, their address, their history.	Owners, admin
Payments	Every payment with its own detail page, linked to the plan and the invoice it belongs to.	Owners, admin
Complaints	The queue. Assign, resolve, close, with the full trail of who did what.	Everyone but customers
Cloths	Balances, pickups, deliveries, top-ups.	Owners, cleaners, admin HIDDEN
Coverage	Who turned up, and which rounds went out.	Owners, admin
Messages	What has been sent and to whom, plus sending one by hand — including society by society over WhatsApp.	Owners, admin
Reports	Money, renewals, cloth balances, service history, over any period.	Owners, admin
People	Staff accounts. A franchise owner may create cleaners; only an administrator creates owners or other administrators.	Owners, admin
Masters	The geography (states, cities, areas, sectors, societies); the price list (car types and models, packages, interior cleaning, durations, cloth bundles); and the website lists (banners, blog categories and tags, team, questions, message wording).	Admin
Blog	The advice articles on the public site, with categories, tags and comments.	Admin
Settings	Everything in section 10.	Admin
Logs	The application log, readable without a server login.	Admin
Backups	Last night's database copy, downloadable, with one on demand.	Admin

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHO SEES IT
Roles	Custom roles — see section 05.	Admin only

4.2

Every number on the dashboard is a way in

The counts are not just figures to read. Clicking one opens the list it counted, already filtered, so the screen that follows shows the same records the tile was counting — *On hold* opens the plans on hold, *No cleaner* opens the ones nobody has been given, the money figures open the payments for the same dates. Nobody has to rebuild the filter by hand and then wonder why their total came out different.

THE ONE EXCEPTION

New plans is deliberately not a link. It counts plans started inside the chosen dates, and the Subscriptions screen has no started-between filter, so a link would open a list that did not match its own number. A tile that lies is worse than a tile that does nothing.

The three lists the day starts with

The requirements document names three things the office should land on. All three exist as saved filters on the Subscriptions screen, reachable in one click from the dashboard:

- **Cars with no cleaner** — every new plan lands here until somebody is given it. This is the landing view.
- **Renewals due** — plans running out, and plans already past their date.
- **Cloths below five** — customers about to run out. **HIDDEN WITH THE CLOTH SERVICE**

What the Paid column is telling you

The figure is what has been paid against that period. Underneath it is the date of the payment behind it, and a way into the whole history.

- **A date** — the receipt is on file. Click it for the payment, or *History* for every payment this car has ever made, across all its renewals.
- **"no receipt on file"** — the amount is recorded on the plan but no payment record sits behind it. Almost every one of these came across from the previous system, which kept the amount on the order and not always the payment. The money was collected; the receipt did not survive the move.
- **"nothing yet"** — genuinely nothing has been paid. A plan the office set up and has not taken money for yet reads like this, and correctly.

WHAT CHANGED

The middle case used to say "nothing yet" as well — directly under a figure saying ₹779 had been paid. It also hid the History link, so the payments on a renewed plan's earlier periods could not be reached from the row in front of you. Both are fixed, and History now spans every period of the car rather than just the one on screen.

Editing a plan

An administrator can edit the whole plan: the customer, the address and society, the package, service type and duration, the dates, the amount, the cleaner, the status, and the details of the payment that was taken against it (method, reference, when it was paid, a note).

TWO RULES ON THIS SCREEN

The car number can only be changed by an administrator. Everyone else sees it as fixed. A franchise owner who edits a plan and attempts to change the registration is told plainly that the change was not applied, rather than being left to assume it was.

The amount already paid is never editable. The plan's price can be corrected; what a customer actually handed over cannot be rewritten after the fact.

4.3

The cleaner's day

- 01 **My round** lists every car assigned to them with a running plan, in society order.
- 02 **Each car is marked** cleaned, skipped, or not found — with a note for anything other than cleaned.
- 03 **Marking a car cleaned messages the customer** that their car has been done today.
- 04 **Cloths are collected and returned** from the same screen, each movement messaging the customer and adjusting the balance. HIDDEN
- 05 **Complaints on their cars** appear in their queue, and they can mark one resolved.

Daily cleaning records are kept for **fifty days** and then removed automatically, as the requirements document asks. The nightly backup runs *before* the removal, so every deleted record is in that night's copy — a retention rule can never be the reason something is unrecoverable.

Who is allowed to do what

5.1

ROLE	SEES	CAN
Administrator	Every branch	Everything, including settings, masters, the blog, backups, roles, and changing a car number.
Franchise owner	Their branch only	Plans, customers, cars, staff, payments and receipts, the complaint queue, the round, attendance, cloths, reports. They create cleaners and customers, not owners or administrators.
Cleaner	Their branch only	Their round, what happened at each car, their own attendance, cloth movements, and resolving a complaint. They cannot close one.
Customer	Their own records only	Their plans, renewing, their payments and invoices, raising and reading their complaints, buying cloths.

Being allowed to use a feature and being allowed to see a particular record are separate questions, and the second is always answered by asking whose record it is. A customer and a franchise owner both hold "view payments"; they see entirely different payments.

5.2

Custom roles

Where the four above are not the right shape — a supervisor who runs the round but must not touch money, an office assistant who answers complaints and nothing else — an administrator can build a role on the Roles screen.

A custom role always **refines** one of the four: it starts from that role's permissions and takes things away or adds from within what that role could already do. It can never grant sight of another sector. That limit is not a setting; there is no way to express it.

Money

6.1

How a price is worked out

Exactly as in the previous system, so historic amounts still reproduce:

```
( car category + package + service type + society surcharge ) × months
- duration discount
+ cloth bundle
```

- The **car** is priced by its category, so every hatchback costs the same whatever the badge says.
- The **society surcharge** is per society, because a basement in a tower block takes longer to reach than a house on a lane.
- The **duration discount** is per duration, because committing to six months is worth something.
- The **cloth bundle** is added after the multiplication, because it is a one-off purchase and not a monthly charge.

All of these are edited on the Masters screen and take effect immediately. Withdrawing a package from sale does not break the plans already on it; those plans are flagged so somebody can move them, rather than being quietly under-priced.

6.2

THE TWO RULES THAT ARE NOT NEGOTIABLE

No price ever comes from the browser. The figure a customer sees is a quote and is thrown away; the amount charged is worked out fresh on our side at the moment of charging. The previous system accepted whatever price the browser posted back, checking only that it was at least one rupee.

Nothing is marked paid except a confirmed payment. Signup, renewal and top-up all open a payment and stop. A plan becomes active only after the gateway's signature has been verified and the gateway has confirmed what it is holding.

Cash and offline payments

A franchise owner can record a payment taken in cash. That is recording money that has already changed hands, not taking one — the amount still comes from the plan, and who recorded it is kept.

Invoices

Every payment gets a numbered invoice, printable by both the office and the customer. The prefix is a setting. The 492 payments carried over from the previous system were numbered retrospectively so none is without one.

Payments that never came back

A customer who pays and then closes the browser before being redirected back leaves a payment that looks unfinished. Every night the system asks the gateway about the last seven days of these and settles the ones that did in fact go through — before the morning's reminders go out, so nobody is chased for money they have already handed over.

Messages

- 7.1** Fifteen messages. Twelve are the ones the requirements document sets out; three more the previous system also sent for its own reasons. The wording of every one is editable in the office, and both the automatic jobs and anything sent by hand use the same edited wording.

#	MESSAGE	SENT WHEN	GOES TO
1	New plan started	A new plan is paid for	Customer
2	New plan, told the office	The same moment — a new car needs a cleaner	The office
3	Plan renewed	A renewal is paid for	Customer
4	Cloths topped up	A cloth top-up is paid for	Customer
5	Complaint raised	A customer raises a complaint	The assigned cleaner
6	Cleaner assigned	A car is given to a cleaner	Customer
7	A message of your own	Sent by hand from the Messages screen	Whoever is chosen
8	Cleaning done	A cleaner marks the car cleaned	Customer
9	Cloths collected	Cloths are picked up	Customer
10	Cloths returned	Cloths are delivered back	Customer
11	Renewal due	Nightly, as the end date approaches	Customer
11	Renewal overdue	Nightly, once the date has passed	Customer
12	Cloths running low	The balance falls below the threshold	Customer
—	Plan paused	A plan is put on hold for being unpaid	Customer
—	Payment received	Every payment that is confirmed — a signup, a renewal or a top-up	Customer

Chasing a renewal, and how often

Nobody is messaged before their date. Once a plan has run out the customer is asked **every day until they renew** — which is how the business has always run it. What changes as the plan moves from expired to paused is what the message says, not how often it arrives:

STATE	HOW OFTEN	WHAT IT SAYS
Expired, still running	Every day	Renew before the cleaning stops. The service is still going.

STATE	HOW OFTEN	WHAT IT SAYS
On hold	Every day	The cleaning has stopped. Renew and it starts again on the next round.

Both numbers are on the Settings screen, so the rhythm can be slowed without a release — they are kept separate so the first can be made gentler without touching the second. The gap is measured from the last message actually sent about that plan, so it is self-correcting: one sent by hand today postpones tomorrow's automatic one.

IT DOES NOT STOP ON ITS OWN

A plan on hold that nobody marks **Ended** is chased every day indefinitely. That is the same as the manual process it replaces, with one difference: a person doing it by hand eventually stopped, and this will not.

Marking a plan Ended is what stops it — so when a customer says they are finished, change the status rather than only making a note of it.

EVERY OVERDUE PLAN IS CHASED, NOT A SAMPLE

It used to send only to plans that had expired *exactly* one, three or seven days ago. Anything that missed those days — because the job had not been set up yet, or the plans came across from the old system — was never chased at all. Eleven plans were overdue and six got a message. Now the state is what decides, not the anniversary, so a plan sixty days past its date is chased like any other.

The receipt

Payment received goes out on every confirmed payment, alongside the welcome or renewal message rather than instead of it: those say what happens next, and this is the proof of what was paid. It carries the amount taken, the date, the receipt number, and **a link to the bill itself**.

THE LINK NEEDS NO ACCOUNT

It opens the receipt as a page the customer can read on their phone and print or save as a PDF. That matters because most customers never make an account, and a bill they can only reach by signing in is a bill they will never open — it becomes a phone call to the office instead.

The link is signed, so changing the id in it does not open somebody else's receipt. It does not expire: the message it arrives in is permanent, and a receipt that stops opening after a few months is a support call at exactly the moment the customer needs it for their own records. Treat it as you would an emailed invoice — anyone the customer forwards it to can read it.

The wording is editable on the Messages screen like any other. Two placeholders are worth knowing: `{paid_amount}` is what was actually taken and `{invoice_link}` is the link to the bill. `{amount}` is something different — it is what the plan costs today, which is the wrong figure to put on a receipt for a payment made last year.

7.2

Nobody gets told the same thing twice

Reminders are kept to one per customer per day, however many times a job runs. Messages about a specific event — a car cleaned, a payment taken — are keyed to that event instead, so

a household with two cars correctly gets one message for each.

The delivery switch

IMPORTANT FOR DEMONSTRATIONS

Messages only actually leave the building when the system is running as the live site *and* delivery is switched on. Anywhere else — a test copy, a demonstration, a developer's machine — every message is written to the record exactly as it would have been sent, with the reason it was held back, and nothing reaches a customer's phone.

This means a demonstration can be given against real data without a single customer being messaged, and the Messages screen will still show precisely what would have gone out.

Society by society

The Messages screen can send to everybody in a chosen society over WhatsApp — for a price change, a holiday, or a note about the water supply.

What happens overnight

- 8.1 Six jobs, and the order matters. Each runs on one server only and never twice at once, because an unattended job that runs twice is worse than one that does not run at all.

TIME	JOB	WHAT IT DOES, AND WHY THEN
00:10	Back up	Copies and verifies the database. First of the lot on purpose: if a later job goes wrong, this copy is from before it did. Keeps fourteen days. A failure raises an alert rather than only writing to a log.
00:20	Settle payments	Asks the gateway about the last seven days of unfinished payments. Nothing else will ever settle these; the browser that would have told us is long closed.
00:40	Clear old rounds	Removes daily cleaning records older than fifty days. After the backup, so the night's copy always contains what is about to go.
09:30	Renewal reminders	Chases plans running out and plans overdue. After settlement, so a customer who paid last night is not chased for it.
19:00	The day's update	One message per customer with what happened to each of their cars — cleaned, not cleaned and why, cloths collected or returned. The hour is a setting. This used to be four separate messages sent the moment the cleaner tapped, which on an early round is six in the morning, and a household with two cars was woken twice.
10:00	Pause the unpaid	Puts plans a week past their date on hold. Last, so it acts on a picture that settlement has corrected and the customer has already been reminded about.
Mon 06:00	Check cloth balances	Weekly, and silent unless a balance and its ledger disagree.

The grace period before pausing, and the cloth warning threshold, are both settings — see section 10.

Built, but switched off

- 9.1 Nothing here is missing or half-finished. Each is complete and tested, and hidden because the business asked for it to be. This is the section to read out when a client asks "what about...".

HIDDEN The cloth ironing service

What exists: the customer's top-up page and the top-up button on each plan; the cloth choice on the signup and renewal forms; the cleaner's pickup and delivery screens; a balance held as an append-only ledger; the below-five warning list; the low-balance message; the weekly consistency check; and cloth bundles on the price list.

What being off does: hides the top-up page, the cloth screens and the cloth choice on the forms. It does not touch a single existing balance or ledger entry.

To turn it on: Settings → Service → *Offer the cloth ironing service*. Everything resumes exactly where it left off.

HIDDEN The advice blog

What exists: the public Advice section and each article's own page; comments, which appear only once approved; the office's writing screen with drafts and a separate publish step; and blog categories and tags on the Masters screen.

What being off does: takes Advice out of the public menu, closes the article pages and the endpoints behind them, hides the Blog screen in the office, and removes the two blog lists from Masters. An old link or a search result lands on the home page rather than on an article.

To turn it on: Settings → Service → *Publish the advice blog*. Every article, category, tag and comment is exactly where it was.

HIDDEN The team page

What exists: the public Team page and the Team list on Masters, with a name, title, photograph and short biography for each person.

What being off does: takes Team out of the public menu, closes the page and its endpoint, and removes the Team list from Masters.

To turn it on: Settings → Service → *Show the team page*.

OFF MEANS OFF EVERYWHERE

Each of these switches closes the public menu, the pages, the office screen, the master lists *and* the addresses behind them at the same moment. Hiding only the menu would leave anybody with an old link - or a search engine that indexed an article last week - reading a section the business has decided not to run.

HIDDEN Renew and Subscribe for signed-in customers

Not shown in the header to a customer who is already signed in, because they do both from their own pages. Staff still see them; the pages still work by address. Reversing this is a one-line change and the developer guide says where.

HIDDEN Cloth top-up in the header

Moved to sit beside the plan it tops up. Somebody thinking about cloths is looking at their car, not at a navigation bar. The page and its address are unchanged.

9.2

OFF BY DEFAULT Only administrators may change a plan

A business-wide switch, for when franchises should stop altering what customers are on. It never restricts an administrator — somebody has to be able to correct a plan, and if this locked everyone out the only way back would be the database.

There is a finer answer as well: a custom role can take plan editing away from one franchise. Use the switch when the policy is "nobody but the office, everywhere, from today", because expressing that by editing each franchise's role one at a time is how one gets missed.

OFF BY DEFAULT Live payments and live messaging

Both the payment gateway and WhatsApp delivery are switched off until the credentials are in place on the live server. This is what makes it safe to run a copy of the system against real data.

ON BY DEFAULT Let search engines list this site

On for the real site; switch it off on any staging copy, or that copy will compete with the real site for its own name in search results.

Things the requirements document asks for that are not yet built

- Choosing the number of cloths while renewing on the *public* renew page. Inside the account it is already there.
- Pending renewals and cloths-below-five as pages of their own rather than saved filters. The information is all present; only the shortcut differs.
- An "are you sure?" step before a cleaner marks a car cleaned.

What you can change yourself

- 10.1** Settings → everything below. No developer, no release, no downtime. Nothing secret lives here: gateway keys and access tokens are kept on the server, where they are not in a database copy an administrator can download.

GROUP	SETTING	DEFAULT
Business	Business name	Eswachh
	Registered name	—
	GSTIN	—
	Address	—
Contact	Phone	—
	Email	—
	WhatsApp number	—
	Office hours	9am to 6pm, Mon–Sat
Billing	Invoice prefix	ESW
	Invoice footer note	—
Service	Days overdue before pausing	7
	Days between renewal reminders	1
	Days between reminders once paused	1
	Warn when cloths fall below	5
	Number for new plan alerts	—
	Only administrators may change a plan	Off
	Offer the cloth ironing service	Off
	Publish the advice blog	Off
	Show the team page	Off
Search & sharing	Page title	Eswachh · Doorstep car cleaning, every day
	Description	Set
	Keywords	Set
	Sharing image	—
	Let search engines list this site	On

GROUP	SETTING	DEFAULT
Policies	Privacy policy	Written, editable
	Terms of service	Written, editable
	Cancellation and refunds	Written, editable

The three policy pages are edited with a formatting toolbar and appear in the footer of the public site. A payment gateway will not approve a business whose site cannot show them, and a customer should not have to ask.

The search and sharing settings

These are what a search engine lists and what appears when somebody pastes a link into WhatsApp. They are written into the page by the server, not added afterwards by the browser, which is the only way a search engine reliably reads them.

Three things happen on top of the words entered here, and none of them need touching:

- **Each page names itself.** The price list is listed as "Plans and prices", the questions page as "Common questions", and so on, rather than eight pages competing under one name.
- **The business is described in a form search engines read directly** — name, phone, address, hours and the plans on sale, taken from Settings and the price list. A detail nobody has filled in is left out rather than sent empty.
- **The questions are offered as search results of their own.** Whatever is live on the Questions screen is what is offered, so editing an answer there changes what Google may show. Nothing is written twice.

WORTH KNOWING

Switching **Let search engines list this site** off withdraws the questions too, not only the pages. A staging copy cannot have its answers picked up and shown against the real business.

Elsewhere, not in Settings

- **The home page banner** — images, headings and the button on each, managed as its own list. The image runs the full width of the page, and a banner carrying one is drawn as a dark band whichever theme the visitor is in, so the headline stays legible over it. The four that ship were drawn for this business rather than bought in; anything uploaded to replace them wants to be about 2400×1000 and quiet down its left-hand side, which is where the words sit.
- **Prices and geography** — the Masters screen.
- **Message wording** — the Messages screen.
- **Advice articles, the team, and questions** — their own screens.

Keeping the data safe

11.1

Backups

Taken every night at ten past midnight, before anything else touches the database, verified after being written, and kept for fourteen days. They are listed on the Backups screen where an administrator can download one or take another on demand. A failed backup raises an alert on the bell in the top bar, because a backup quietly failing for three months is how a restore turns out to be impossible on the day it is needed.

What is kept, and for how long

RECORD	KEPT
Daily cleaning records	Fifty days, then removed automatically
Payments and invoices	Indefinitely
Plans, customers, cars	Indefinitely. Deleting hides rather than erases, so history stays intact
Messages sent	Indefinitely
Cloth ledger	Indefinitely, and never edited — corrections are new entries
Backups	Fourteen days

What somebody cannot see

Separation is enforced at the point every query is made, not by remembering to filter each screen. It is closed by default: somebody covering no sectors sees nothing rather than everything. A record in a sector they do not cover produces the same response as one that does not exist, so refusing an answer never confirms that there was something to refuse.

A customer with no sector recorded is visible only to an administrator, and stays that way until one is given — which is why the form insists on it.

Signing in

Every account carried over from the previous system — customers, franchises and administrators — signs in with the credentials they already had. Customers can sign in with a code sent to their phone instead. Those codes expire, and a wrong guess does not extend one.

Where to go next. Anything in this guide that needs changing — a flag flipped, wording altered, a rule adjusted — is covered in *developer-guide.pdf*, beside this file, which names the exact file and line for each.